IELTS ACADEMIC · STUDENT WORKSHEET

IELTS Academic Set 24

All sections

Name: _____ Date: _____

HOW TO USE THIS WORKSHEET

Work through each IELTS part in order. Reading passages stay with their questions; charts and diagrams appear next to their tasks. Open the live practice page for Listening audio and Speaking recordings.

Staff solutions and scripts are supplied separately.

Listening

Use the separately supplied audio. Write one response for each question.

IELTS Academic Listening Practice - Set 24

Original unofficial practice material aligned to the public IELTS Academic Listening format. It is not an official IELTS test.

You will hear four recordings once only. Answer Questions 1-40 as you listen. At the end, you will have 2 minutes to check your answers.

Spelling must be correct. Follow the word and number limit shown for each completion task.

Part 1

Questions 1-6

Complete the registration form. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER for each answer.

1. Dog's name: _____

2. Breed: _____

3. Age: _____ years

4. Final four microchip digits: _____

5. Previous vaccination month: _____

6. Preferred confirmation method: _____

Questions 7-10

Choose the correct answer, A, B or C.

7. Which clinic location does Niamh choose?

A the mobile clinic beside the library

B the main surgery on O'Connell Street

C the van at the school car park

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8. Why does Niamh reject the earlier appointments?

A Bramble is nervous in the morning

B public transport is unavailable

C she has a work meeting

9. What must Niamh bring to the appointment?

A the microchip certificate

B the vaccination record

C proof of address

10. How will Niamh pay the clinic fee?

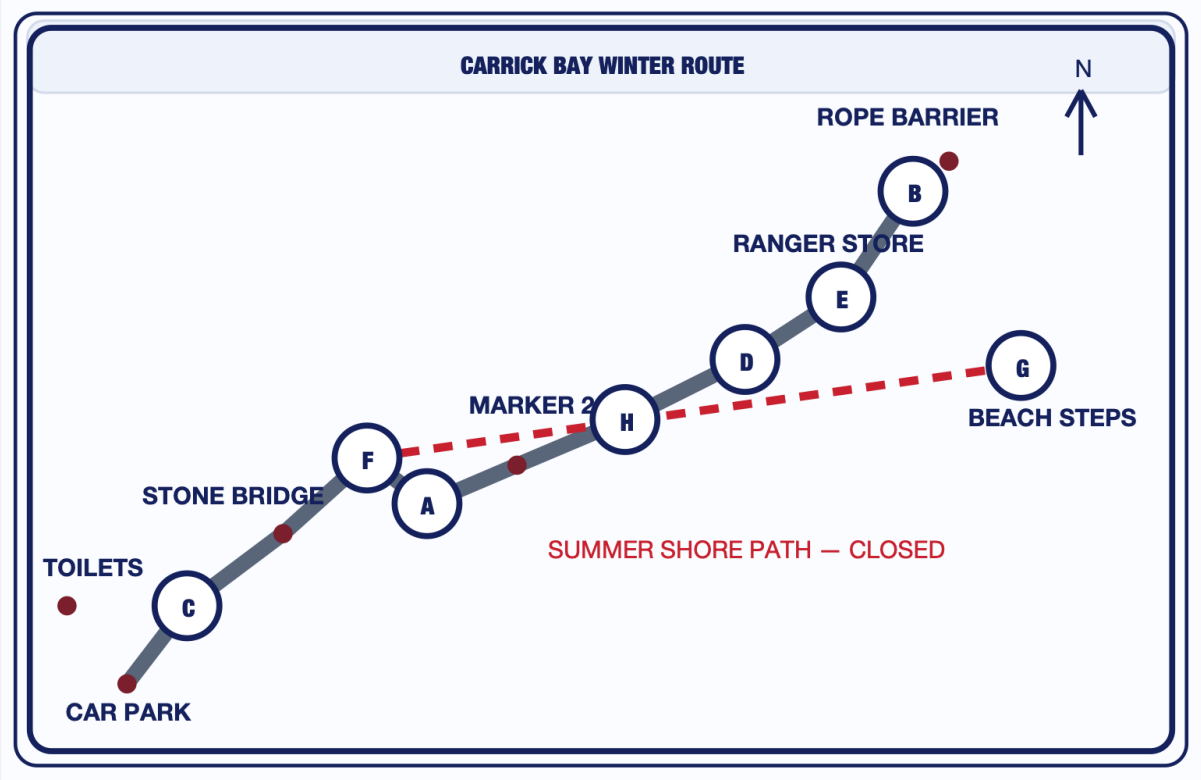
A by card on arrival

B online before the visit

C in cash after the appointment

Part 2

None



Questions 11-16

Label the map. Choose the correct letter, A-H, for Questions 11-16.

11. information board

12. tide gate

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13. start of winter diversion

14. emergency marker 3

15. warming shelter

16. lookout point

Questions 17-20

Answer the questions. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS for each answer.

17. What should walkers check before leaving home?

18. What colour are the emergency markers?

19. What should walkers keep in a waterproof bag?

20. What should walkers do if water covers the lower band at the tide gate?

Part 3

Questions 21-26

Choose the correct answer, A, B or C.

21. Why do the group decide to use replica swatches?

- **A** They fade more quickly.
- **B** They avoid risk to collection objects.
- **C** They are easier to photograph.

22. What will provide the main colour measurements?

- **A** weekly photographs
- **B** a visual rating scale
- **C** colorimeter readings

23. What will be kept equal between the two lamp groups?

- **A** the exposure time
- **B** the total light dose
- **C** the apparent brightness

24. What is the purpose of the dark control?

- **A** to detect colour change not caused by light
- **B** to provide spare swatches
- **C** to measure humidity inside a cupboard

25. How will the students reduce the effect of shelf position?

- **A** record the temperature once
- **B** use only the centre of the shelf
- **C** randomise positions each week

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26. What main limitation will the report acknowledge?

A Replica dyes cannot be measured accurately.

B Accelerated exposure may differ from slow gallery ageing.

C LED spectra cannot be compared at equal dose.

Questions 27-30

Who is responsible for each decision? Choose A, B or C. You may use any letter more than once.

A	Mei Tan
B	Lachlan Price
C	Olivia Mercer

27. maintaining the dye preparation log

28. calibrating the colorimeter

29. approving the maximum exposure ceiling

30. contacting the textile workshop

Part 4

Questions 31-36

Complete the notes. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS for each answer.

31. Buoyancy is aided by _____ within the outer tissue.

32. A _____ slows the entry of sea water.

33. Seeds may be transported by _____.

34. Storm debris can trap seeds at the _____.

35. Rain supplies _____ that removes salt.

36. The emerging root needs _____ for anchorage.

Questions 37-40

Complete the sentences. Write ONE WORD ONLY for each answer.

37. A flotation trial does not establish seed _____.

38. Laboratory tanks simplify coastal _____.

39. Small field collections may introduce _____ bias.

40. After germination, _____ may prevent permanent colonisation.

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Reading

Read the three passages and answer Questions 1-40. You have 60 minutes, including checking time.

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The Ground Beneath a Street Tree

A A newly planted street tree may appear to occupy an open square of soil, yet most of the space on which its future depends is hidden. Roots need a connected volume containing air, water and mineral nutrients. In a forest, pores are renewed by organisms, fallen material and changing moisture. Beside a road, the same ground is expected to carry pedestrians, parked vehicles and paving. Engineers commonly compact it so that the surface will not sink. This creates a conflict: the density that protects pavement can remove the larger pores through which roots extend and oxygen moves.

B Compaction affects more than the mechanical effort required for a root tip to advance. Closely packed particles slow drainage after heavy rain, but they may also hold too little plant-available water during a dry spell. Gas exchange declines, and roots remain shallow where conditions are less hostile. Shallow roots are then vulnerable to heat and physical disturbance, while a small underground network limits the crown that can be supported. Designers must consequently treat soil volume, continuity and connection to water as parts of one system.

C One response is structural soil. Large angular stones form a load-bearing skeleton, and a measured soil mixture occupies spaces between them. When properly specified, the stones transfer pressure from the pavement while the soil in their voids offers routes for fine roots. The approach can extend a rooting medium beneath areas that must remain firm. However, the usable soil fraction is smaller than the total excavated volume because stone takes up much of that volume. Structural soil is not ordinary topsoil with rubble added; stone size, proportion and installation determine whether it carries loads without closing root passages.

D A different approach uses soil cells: modular frames installed below paving. Their columns and decks support the surface, leaving large compartments of lightly compacted soil inside. Cells can provide more actual soil per cubic metre of excavation than a stone skeleton, and linked units can create a continuous root zone along a street. They require careful engineering around utility lines, inspection points and drainage outlets. They also cost more initially and need sufficient excavation depth. The advantage is not predictable roots, but separating the load-bearing job from the biological job.

E Soil structure is only part of the underground partnership. Many tree roots associate with mycorrhizal fungi. Fine fungal threads called hyphae spread beyond the root surface and explore pores too small for roots themselves. In exchange for carbon produced by the tree, the fungi can help obtain water and mineral nutrients. This relationship is not a universal product for every planting pit. Fungal communities depend on host species, soil chemistry, moisture and disturbance. Suitable fungi may already be present, whereas an introduced strain may fail. The practical lesson is to protect living soil rather than assume that an inoculant will repair a badly designed root environment.

F Water management links the engineered and biological elements. Runoff from a pavement can be directed into the rooting system, reducing demand on drains and helping a tree through dry periods. Yet an inlet without an overflow may leave roots waterlogged, and dirty runoff may carry salt or other contaminants. Air vents, permeable surfaces and inspection access can be useful, but each component must fit the site. A narrow street with frequent excavation for utilities presents different risks from a broad pedestrian plaza. Maintenance crews also need to know where water enters and how blockages can be cleared. A design that performs well at installation can decline if these operational details are treated as someone else's responsibility.

G Comparisons among planting systems are difficult because tree species, climates and monitoring periods vary. Rapid root extension in one trial does not by itself prove better long-term survival, and laboratory measures cannot reproduce every street disturbance. Even so, research supports a consistent principle: roots benefit when load support is achieved without eliminating connected, aerated soil. Structural soil and soil cells solve that problem differently, while fungal partners work within the environment those systems provide. The best choice may combine methods or use neither if adequate open ground already exists. Rather than buying a named technology first, planners should define the required soil volume, water route, pavement load and maintenance access, then select a construction that meets those site conditions. This planning keeps technical and biological priorities clearly visible.

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Questions 1-7

Complete the summary below. Choose NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS from the passage for each answer.

Questions 8-13

Match each statement with the correct feature, A-D. You may use any letter more than once.

A	compacted conventional soil
B	structural soil
C	soil cells
D	mycorrhizal fungi

8. Its useful soil quantity is less than the excavated volume suggests.

9. It may already occur naturally at a planting site.

10. It can leave roots close to the hottest and most disturbed ground.

11. It requires routes to be planned around buried services.

12. Its performance depends on the proportions and installation of stone and soil.

13. It explores spaces that tree roots cannot enter.

From Raised Letters to a Six-Dot Cell

A For readers who use touch, a writing system must solve two related problems. Marks must be distinct enough for a fingertip to recognise, and they must be compact enough to scan without repeatedly moving the hand. Early educators often began with familiar printed letters raised above the page. This made sense to sighted teachers because the shapes already represented literacy to them. For learners, however, a curved or elaborate outline could require slow tracing. The books were large, production was expensive, and the method mainly supported reading. A pupil could identify prepared type but had no equally convenient way to compose a private note or complete an exercise independently.

B In nineteenth-century France, experiments therefore shifted from copying visual shapes to arranging simple raised points. A military code proposed by Charles Barbier used patterns of dots that could be read without light. It demonstrated that touch did not need to imitate ink, but its cells were relatively tall and contained more positions than a finger could grasp at once. Users had to move along a pattern to interpret it. The code had been designed for messages rather than for the grammar, punctuation and varied texts of everyday literacy. Its importance lay less in becoming a finished school system than in showing that a small set of embossed points could carry information.

C Louis Braille encountered such ideas while studying at the Royal Institute for Blind Youth in Paris. Blind after a childhood injury, he understood the classroom problem as a reader and writer rather than only as a designer. By the age of fifteen he had developed an initial tactile system. Its basic unit was a six-dot cell arranged in two columns. Because the whole cell fitted beneath a fingertip, a reader could recognise a configuration without tracing a large outline. Sixty-four possible combinations, including the blank cell, supplied a compact code for letters, punctuation and other signs. Economy of space also meant that lines and pages could carry more information than many raised-letter books.

D The cell addressed writing as well as reading. A slate held paper in position while openings guided a stylus that pressed dots into it. Since the dots were embossed from the reverse side, the writer worked in a direction that initially required practice before turning the sheet over to read. The tools were portable and did not depend on a printing workshop. This changed the learner's role: instead of receiving only books made by others, a student could take notes, answer questions and exchange messages. The physical simplicity of six positions also allowed later mechanical devices to assign one key to each dot, so combinations could be pressed together.

E Adoption was not immediate. Institutions had invested in competing raised systems, teachers differed over methods, and authorities did not automatically accept a code created by a young blind student. Braille continued refining the system and

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extended it for music and mathematics. He died in 1852 without seeing the full international reach of his work. Over time, practical use by readers and writers supplied an argument that official preference could not easily dismiss. The system spread through schools and libraries, although languages developed their own conventions. Its success was therefore not a single moment of invention followed by instant agreement; it was a process of testing, teaching, adaptation and institutional change.

F The same design principle survived changes in production. A mechanical braillewriter uses six main keys corresponding to the cell's dots. Embossers can produce pages from digital files, while refreshable displays raise and lower pins so that electronic text can be read line by line. These devices alter speed, storage and distribution, but they do not make the tactile code obsolete. A digital document still needs rules that tell a display which dot pattern represents a character or symbol. Nor has technology removed every constraint: embossed volumes occupy substantial space, refreshable equipment can be costly, and transcription must represent layouts, mathematics and music accurately rather than convert ordinary print mechanically.

G The history also warns against measuring an accessible system only by resemblance to the dominant one. Raised print preserved the appearance of letters but imposed a heavy perceptual burden on touch. The dot cell changed the design question from 'How can print be felt?' to 'What can a fingertip distinguish quickly and what can a writer produce directly?' That shift joined finger span, page economy and independent composition in one solution. Modern audio and speech tools offer valuable additional access, yet they serve different purposes from spelling, punctuation and close textual study. The continuing use of braille reflects not resistance to new technology but the value of a code designed around active literacy rather than passive receipt. It endures.

Questions 14-20

Do the following statements agree with the information in Passage 2? Write TRUE, FALSE or NOT GIVEN.

14. Raised-letter books allowed pupils to write exercises using the same method.

15. Barbier's code was originally intended for schoolchildren.

16. The size of Barbier's cells made them difficult to perceive in one touch.

17. Louis Braille had lost his sight before attending the Paris institute.

18. The six-dot cell offered fewer than fifty possible patterns.

19. Education authorities adopted Braille's system immediately.

20. The passage states that one language now uses more braille symbols than all others.

Questions 21-26

Answer the questions below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

21. What held the paper steady while a stylus was used?

22. What could students make during lessons once they could write for themselves?

23. For which two specialised subjects did Braille extend his system?

24. Which places helped the system spread over time?

25. What rises and falls in a refreshable display?

26. What kind of study does the final paragraph contrast with listening to speech tools?

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A Surface That Cools Under the Sun

A A roof under a clear sky participates in two energy exchanges that are easy to confuse. Sunlight arrives mainly at short wavelengths and can heat the surface if absorbed. The warm surface also emits energy at longer, thermal-infrared wavelengths. Ordinary materials may lose some heat by this second route at night, when solar input has disappeared. Achieving cooling in daytime is harder because even modest absorption of intense sunlight can exceed the infrared loss. A successful passive cooling surface must therefore perform two apparently separate optical tasks: reject most incoming solar energy and emit thermal radiation strongly in the wavelengths through which that radiation can escape.

B The escape route is not equally open across the infrared spectrum. Gases in the atmosphere absorb many wavelengths and return part of the energy towards the ground. In a band commonly called the atmospheric window, however, the air is relatively transparent under suitable conditions. Radiation emitted in this band can travel towards the cold upper atmosphere and space. The surface is not producing cold; it is losing energy by radiation faster than it gains energy from its surroundings. This distinction matters because a material described simply as a strong infrared emitter may radiate strongly where the atmosphere is opaque. Its measured total emission can look impressive while the useful outward pathway remains limited.

C Designers use different structures to combine solar reflection with selective or broad thermal emission. A pale top layer may scatter visible and near-infrared sunlight, while particles, pores or molecular vibrations provide emission in the mid-infrared. Beneath it, a metallic reflector can return radiation that would otherwise be absorbed by the building. Some experimental coatings use carefully chosen particle sizes; others use layered films or porous polymers. The relevant result is the spectrum of the complete assembly, not the reputation of one ingredient. A white surface can still absorb a troublesome band of sunlight, and a highly reflective metal can be a poor thermal emitter unless another layer supplies that function.

D Laboratory tests often report solar reflectance and infrared emittance as material properties. Those measurements are necessary, but they do not directly state how much a room will cool. Heat also reaches the surface through warm air, contact with the roof below and moisture. Wind can either remove accumulated heat or bring heat to a surface that has fallen below air temperature. Insulation limits conductive exchange with the interior, so the same coating may produce a large surface-temperature change but a smaller change indoors. Conversely, reducing heat flow through a poorly insulated roof may matter greatly to occupants even if the coating never becomes colder than the surrounding air.

E Weather narrows the theoretical pathway. Water vapour absorbs infrared radiation, so humid air can partly close the atmospheric window. Clouds are stronger emitters than a clear upper sky and can send thermal radiation downward. The angle at which a surface views the sky also matters: nearby walls, trees and roof equipment may replace part of that cold view with warmer objects. A horizontal sample on an open test platform therefore has an advantage that a vertical facade in a dense street may not share. Dust, ageing and rain alter optical properties over time. Performance claims based on a clean new specimen and a few clear days cannot automatically be transferred to every climate or orientation.

F Researchers quantify the balance with a net cooling power. Outgoing thermal radiation is counted as a gain for cooling; absorbed sunlight, downward atmospheric radiation and non-radiative heat transfer count against it. Each term changes with surface temperature and conditions, so a single efficiency percentage can conceal important assumptions. A test conducted at night removes the largest solar term and is useful for studying emission, but it cannot establish daytime performance by itself. Likewise, reporting only a surface temperature without a reference surface makes weather effects difficult to separate. Strong evidence clearly combines spectral measurements, an energy-balance model and outdoor comparisons.

G The path from sample to building adds another scale. Electricity savings depend on how a building is operated. The roof deck and insulation determine how much of the altered surface balance reaches the interior. In an unconditioned structure, the valued outcome may instead be fewer hours above a dangerous indoor temperature. Thus a claim that a film reflects a certain fraction of sunlight is a statement about the material, not yet a statement about energy bills, comfort or public-health benefit.

H This layered reasoning explains both the promise and the caution surrounding radiative cooling. The physical mechanism is real: a surface can send heat through a spectral opening while resisting solar gain. Yet the magnitude of that effect moves through a chain - from optical spectrum, to surface energy balance, to roof construction, to indoor conditions, and finally to human or energy outcomes. A useful diagram should keep these levels distinct. It should show incoming

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sunlight meeting a reflective layer, thermal emission leaving the surface through the atmospheric window, and conductive exchange moderated by insulation above the roof deck. It should not imply that every emitted ray reaches space or that a cooler coating guarantees an equally large reduction inside.

Questions 27-33

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, A-J.

27. A small amount of absorbed sunlight

28. The atmospheric route for outgoing heat

29. The performance of a single coating ingredient

30. An experiment conducted only after dark

31. An unobstructed horizontal laboratory sample

32. A building's eventual electricity saving

33. A responsible account of the technology

Questions 34-40

Label the diagram below. Choose NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS from the passage for each answer.

34.

35.

36.

37.

38.

39.

40.

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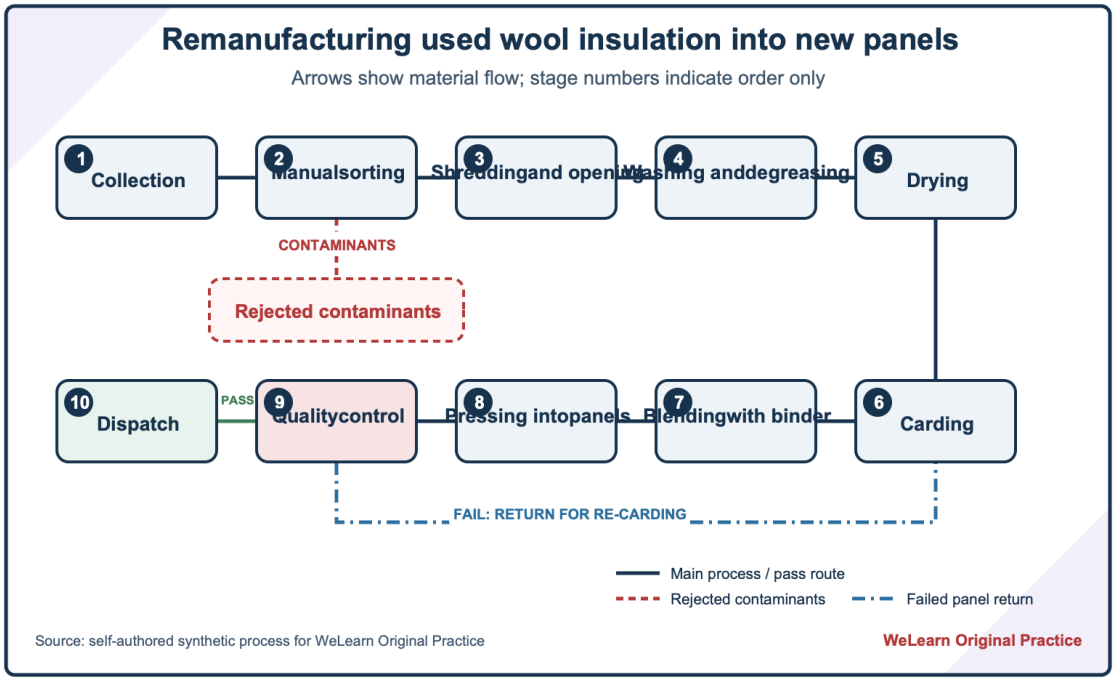
Writing

Writing Task 1

- You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.
- Write at least 150 words.

The diagram below shows how used wool insulation is remanufactured into new panels.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.



Writing Task 2

- You should spend about 40 minutes on this task.
- Write at least 250 words.
- Task 2 contributes twice as much as Task 1 to the Writing score.

Some people think that schools should shorten the long summer holiday and distribute the same total amount of holiday time more evenly throughout the school year. Others believe that a long summer holiday should be kept.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion.

Assume that the total amount of compulsory teaching time over the year remains unchanged.

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

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Speaking

Part 1

Topic 1

Now, let's talk about handwriting.

- When do you usually write things by hand?
- How easy is it for other people to read your handwriting?
- Do you prefer writing by hand or typing on a keyboard? Why?
- Has the amount you write by hand changed in recent years?

Topic 2

Let's talk about weather forecasts.

- When do you usually check the weather forecast?
- Where do you prefer to get weather forecasts?
- How accurate do weather forecasts usually seem where you live?
- Have you ever changed your plans because of a weather forecast?

Topic 3

Now, let's talk about footwear.

- What kind of footwear do you wear most often?
- When choosing footwear, is comfort more important to you than appearance?
- How do you usually decide when to buy new footwear?
- Do you wear different kinds of footwear for different occasions?

Part 2

- Now I'm going to give you a topic, and I'd like you to talk about it for one to two minutes.
- You have one minute to prepare. You can make some notes if you wish.

Describe a traditional craft that an older person taught you or showed you.

You should say:

- what the craft was and who the person was
- how the person demonstrated the craft
- what you tried to do or learned

and explain why you think this knowledge was worth preserving.

- Would you like to practise this craft again in the future?
- Is it easy for younger people to learn this craft where you live?

Thank you. Now we'll move on to Part 3.

Part 3

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We've been talking about learning a traditional craft from an older person. I'd now like to discuss how practical knowledge is passed on and valued more generally.

- Why can watching an experienced person be more useful than reading instructions when learning a craft?
- How well can videos and digital records preserve skills that are usually passed from person to person?
- How do pay and social status affect whether people choose craft work as a career?
- Should schools teach traditional crafts, or are apprenticeships a better way to learn them?
- When a traditional craft is changed for modern markets, what might be gained or lost?
- Which traditional crafts are most likely to survive in the future, and why?

Thank you. That is the end of the speaking test.

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Objective answer sheets

Listening

1		21	
2		22	
3		23	
4		24	
5		25	
6		26	
7		27	
8		28	
9		29	
10		30	
11		31	
12		32	
13		33	
14		34	
15		35	
16		36	
17		37	
18		38	
19		39	
20		40	

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Reading

1		21	
2		22	
3		23	
4		24	
5		25	
6		26	
7		27	
8		28	
9		29	
10		30	
11		31	
12		32	
13		33	
14		34	
15		35	
16		36	
17		37	
18		38	
19		39	
20		40	

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Writing response paper

Task 1 - response page 1 of 2

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Task 1 - response page 2 of 2

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Task 2 - response page 1 of 3

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Task 2 - response page 2 of 3

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Task 2 - response page 3 of 3

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Speaking notes

Use notes only for the permitted preparation time.

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